Nikos Vasileiadis

Software Engineering Manager · Leeds, UK (GMT/BST - 1 hour behind CET) · British & Greek (EU) Citizen
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Summary

Engineering Manager with 20+ years in technology and 9 years in leadership - 4 of them line-managing engineers - working across regulated industries - financial services, utilities, energy, and public sector technology. I build teams, maintain platforms, and focus on creating the right conditions for people to do good work. Hands-on when a small team or a critical path needs it; hands-off when the team scales. Introduced structured delivery in three resistant environments (financial services, a global brand agency, and a greenfield platform team). Currently managing platform and content services at Utility Warehouse (FTSE 250), a UK multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile and insurance.

Based in Leeds, UK. Greek (EU) citizen - full right to work in the Netherlands and across the EU. Open to remote roles with Dutch and European organisations. The timezone overlap with CET is seamless.

What I Bring

- **People & teams** - Building and retaining remote engineering teams with cultural intelligence; measurement-led via DORA metrics, team health tracking, and Heartbeat surveys; reorg communication on a cadence - including empty updates when there's nothing new.
- **Organisational design** - Navigating restructurings, building teams from scratch, aligning team structures with what the business actually needs. Have built the same team twice from zero; staff complementary pairs, not just headcount.
- **Platform & infrastructure** - Running critical platform services with clear SLAs and operational discipline for 15+ dependent engineering teams.
- **Design systems** - From co-creating an open-source design system (Pulsar) to leading enterprise-wide adoption across 20 teams.
- **Commercial awareness** - a six-figure vendor portfolio across six platform services, CapEx/OpEx planning, and vendor evaluation; commercial literacy from sitting with compliance, marketing, data, and IT.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 - multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)
Jul 2023 - Present · United Kingdom · Remote

- **Team & retention:** Grew to 8 technical reports across three teams with separate backlogs - web/CMS/tracking, mobile, and design systems - alongside a Product Manager. Everyone who wanted to stay, stayed - 100% retention through three reorganisations across three departments in 25 months; all reductions were organisational, zero voluntary attrition. Involved in hiring 2 external engineers and 4 internal transfers.
- **Growing people, measurably:** Supported 3 promotions (Associate → Mid, Mid → Senior) with evidence-based cases informed by DORA metrics and monthly Peakon Heartbeat surveys - acting on the signals, not just collecting them. Developed engineers who hadn't found the right home elsewhere in the organisation. Engineers I mentored are now Engineering Managers, both inside and outside the company.
- **Navigating restructurings:** Took responsibility for scoping team migrations - mapping scope, aligning stakeholders, and building consensus for where the team should sit. Negotiated skill inbound - a Senior Engineer with mobile expertise - when a mobile backlog was added, rather than stretching the existing team thin; argued successfully for keeping the Design Systems team separate when a restructuring proposal would have merged it into another team - the team that later enabled the company-wide rebrand.
- **Documentation & upskilling:** Wrote over 100 articles of technical documentation for a team that inherited an undocumented legacy CMS. When the team needed Kubernetes knowledge, I learned it first, then trained the team and documented it. Engineers own RFCs and present at cross-team forums.
- **Rebranding programme (Oct 2025 - Apr 2026):** The team delivered UW's brand refresh across 522 pages of the uw.co.uk estate - the critical path: other teams' rebranding couldn't go live until we shipped. I went back on the tools for the duration - building critical-path components and writing the automated migration scripts that saved content editors hundreds of manual hours.

- **Platform reliability:** uw.co.uk operated against a 99.99% SLO - a single incident in the current year, resolved within hours - with <3s page load on critical pages. The estate: 522 pages, 3,157 media assets, 1,090 shortlinks, 218 redirects. Supporting 8 content teams (33 users) and 15+ engineering teams across six platform services: Contentful CMS, Google Tag Manager, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, OneTrust.
- **Design Systems (Hearth):** The Hearth Design System reached 20 engineering and product teams (15 full adoption, 5 partial), removing thousands of hours of duplicated work across the organisation.
- **CMS migration (Apostrophe → Contentful):** Replaced a legacy CMS that had no SLA, no SSO, and an ageing tech stack. A 2-month evaluation across 10 vendors led to Contentful on an enterprise contract, chosen for enterprise-grade SLAs and support. Zero-disruption migration; three marketing teams (~18 people) gained structured content models and scheduling. The in-house delivery platform (Next.js / React / TypeScript) runs its own GraphQL API over Contentful's content APIs - request bundling, query optimisation, and on-demand content revalidation, a layer above what the vendor provides.
- **Working with constraints (2025-present):** With the team at a specialist core of 2 engineers after the reorganisations, I took on Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside my management role. The team continued to deliver across 6 platform services without breaching the platform SLO, with full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate.

Lead Software Engineer

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 - multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)
May 2022 - Jul 2023 · United Kingdom · Remote

Joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing - no department, no precedent, no documentation.

- Started as three - myself, a Product Manager, and an Associate Engineer - and held that shape for a full year. Line-managed the engineer from May 2022: for my first year I reported directly to a VP of Engineering - no Head of Engineering in between - so people responsibility was mine from the start, 14 months before the title followed. Grew to five in May 2023 with two external hires; promoted the founding Associate to Software Engineer a month later - a promotion case I was asked to prepare and drive while still Lead. Renamed Content Capability (Nov 2022) and moved into the Platforms department (May 2023) - the first of three reorganisations the team would outlast.
- Set up a Scrum environment with structured backlog and predictable delivery, filling Product Manager gaps when needed. Conducted systematic discovery on the legacy CMS, authored the team's foundational documentation.
- Led the vendor evaluation that resulted in UW adopting Contentful as its enterprise CMS. Presented findings and full audit trail to leadership.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

IMA-HOME
Jan 2020 - Apr 2022 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Combined frontend architecture with Scrum Master responsibilities for global clients (Adidas, MARS).

- Introduced structured Agile/Scrum practices to an agency that had been running on ad-hoc delivery. Result: measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos.
- Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's global web presence - a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support.

Senior Digital Developer & Scrum Master

Leeds Building Society (5th largest UK building society · £31B+ assets)
Oct 2018 - Jan 2020 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Maintained public-facing digital assets for the UK's 5th largest building society - a regulated financial services environment - while mentoring teams on code quality and UX standards.

- Introduced Agile and Scrum to LBS for the first time - voluntary ways-of-working forums that grew championing into a parallel Scrum Master role, then a formal Interim SM appointment (Jun-Oct 2019) to stabilise Digital Transformation alongside external consultants.

UX Interface Developer & Scrum Master

Jadu
Jan 2017 - Oct 2018 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Designed UIs and developed features for an award-winning CMS used by UK Local Authorities, universities, and third-sector organisations. Strict focus on accessibility and W3C standards.

- Co-created **Pulsar** - an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is where my design systems specialism started.
- Owned the full feature lifecycle for the CMS product - contextual inquiry at client sites (councils, universities), field research reports, mockups, usability testing, and production release.
- Gained hands-on Agile leadership through a rotating Scrum Master model.

Early Career, Teaching & Community

Oct 2005 - Dec 2016 (11 years)

Provincial northern Greece - Xanthi, where I grew up; Serres, where I studied: no tech industry and, after 2010, barely an economy. I built the career anyway, and led long before I had a title for it.

- **Web development & freelancing (2005-2015):** Delivered 40+ web projects across Greece and internationally - from local non-profits to a Bitcoin job board for a client in California. Managed client relationships, billing (40/40/20 payment terms), and coordinated with distributed teams.
- **Teaching & mentorship (2006-2012):** Earned a Certified Training Professional qualification. Taught ECDL to adult learners for a year. Privately tutored a student in programming and hardware - that student went on to earn a BSc and MSc in Manchester and is now an Engineering Manager.
- **Community & civic technology (2008-2014):** Co-founded the Serres Linux Users Group, organised FOSSCOMM 2012 (a 350-person national open-source conference), and managed digital presence for UNESCO Serres, the local Natural History Museum, and community organisations. This work directly shaped my later community involvement in the UK.
- **UK agency work (2015-2016):** Relocated to Leeds. Built responsive e-commerce for global brands (Vivienne Westwood) and focused on frontend performance.

Community & Volunteering

Mentor, WRK digital *(Feb 2023-Present)*: Part of a peer mentoring network spanning EMs, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code *(Aug 2023-Jan 2024)*: Supported people entering the industry through their first engineering roles.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds *(Jan 2019-Mar 2020)*: Revived an inactive chapter; organised conferences, workshops, and meetups.

Education

International University of Greece - Serres Campus
BSc Informatics Engineering (2007-2012) - strong grades in software engineering, programming, and databases. Left without the certificate when the Greek economic crisis hit; the freelance business I was already running became the career.

Credentials

AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders · Udemy, Mar 2026
Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023
Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022-2023
Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021
Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full credentials list available on the Credentials page.